



Dr. Shirley Jackson helped develop optic fibre.

completed successful experiments in theoretical physics. Her vast knowledge of physics and its diverse applications enabled critical advancements in telecommunications research while she was employed at Bell Laboratories. She did this by studying the fundamental properties of various materials, particularly substances used in the semiconductor industry.

Dr. Jackson conducted breakthrough scientific research that paved the way for others to invent communication devices such as the portable fax, touch tone telephone, caller ID and call waiting features. She also played an instrumental role in developing sensitive solar cells and fiber optic cables for speedy data communication.

GUI GURU

Susan Kare, a graphical designer and artist, didn't invent anything as such, but she played an important role in ensuring people using early computers weren't intimidated by the tech inside them. How? By designing a great, easy-to-understand, iconic graphical user interface.

Kare was the designer who worked with Steve Jobs, bringing her sophisticated typography and iconic graphic design skills to Apple Inc. Many of the now-common interface elements of the Mac, such as the command icon, are all credited to Susan Kare, which she apparently found while looking through a book of symbols.

If Apple's where Kare earned her initial fame and reputation, her diverse work with other technology companies at the time helped her leave a lasting impact on how people perceived them. After Jobs was forced out, Kare left Apple to work with Microsoft, where she applied her design skills to the Windows 3.0 OS, creating quite a few of its iconic graphical elements. Remember the card deck of Solitaire? Yup, that's her work. Kare was also the Creative Director of NeXT for a while.

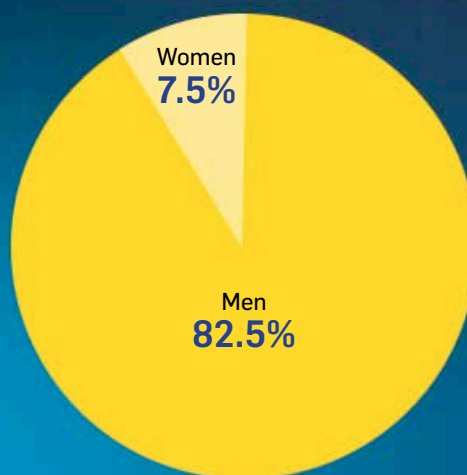
She has also worked on Facebook's "digital gifts," including the friendly rubber ducky found on the popular social network.

FROM OLPC TO VR

Dr. Mary Lou Jepsen is a technology maverick in every imaginable aspect. Her efforts across various technology verticals and companies have strived towards making a big difference on not only how technology is consumed, but also on removing barriers to access of technology.

For example, in 2005, with Nicholas Negroponte, she co-founded 'One Laptop per Child' ('OLPC') to build \$100 computers for the majority of the developing world, ensuring poor children get access to affordable computers that they can use and play with. As Chief Technology Officer she not only invented, but also

GENDER AND PATENTING



This chart shows the percentage of men and women receiving patents in the US. **While women receive only 7.5% of all patents, only 5.5% are commercialized patents, the most lucrative type.** The most important factor contributing to this patent gender gap is men's over-representation in patent-intensive fields such as electrical and mechanical engineering.

Patent inequality in the USA

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